

THE LAST TRAIN TO CONEY ISLAND

Event 92 · Call of Cthulhu 7th Ed · New York City, 1979 · 4–6 Investigators · 3–5 hours · Sunday, midnight

Every gang in the city is hunting the Warriors. The gate opens at 6 AM. The token in their pocket is the only key.

KEEPER TRUTH

Cyrus, war chief of the Gramercy Riffs, was shot dead at the cross-gang Van Cortlandt summit. The Warriors were framed. The real killer: Lester Creed, vessel of the Black Conductor — an ancient transit entity that has ridden New York's rail infrastructure since before the first IRT line was laid. Cyrus had discovered what the Third Rail Choir was doing beneath the city and was secretly building a cross-gang coalition to stop it. The Choir moved first. Cyrus died pressing a brass token into one investigator's hand — 'Don't let it reach the end of the line.' That token fits the Stillwell Avenue breaker shrine. Without it, the gate opens at dawn. The Black Conductor does not want to destroy New York. It wants to run it. The ward network across the entire subway system was its cage. The cage is crumbling from the north south since midnight.

■ INTRODUCTION — VAN CORTLANDT PARK (~20 min)

Locations: Van Cortlandt Park, the Bronx, midnight

Cyrus addresses massed gangs at a historic summit — peace, unity, enough muscle to own the city. Shot mid-speech. Someone screams the Warriors did it. The floodlights die the instant the sirens start. One investigator can reach Cyrus before the crowd closes — he presses the warm brass token into their palm. One investigator glimpses Lester Creed moving calmly against the fleeing crowd, watching with mild professional interest. Do not deliberate. Drive the investigators out immediately. The city closes the moment Cyrus falls.

Clues / handouts: Brass token (H5) — warm, stays warm. Shell casing if park is searched. Glimpse of Creed.

Pacing: No deliberation. The city closes the moment Cyrus falls — push them out within 2 minutes of the shot.

■ ACT ONE — THE BRONX RUN (~50 min)

Locations: Cemetery Rail Cut · Witness stairwell · Gun Hill Butchers · Transit concourse · First train south

Cemetery Rail Cut: a Riffs lookout dead by a retaining wall — no wound, no bruising, eyes burned flat silver. Core temp unexpectedly cold. Occult (Hard): seated position matches voluntary consciousness-transfer postures. Matchbook under a rail tie bears the Third Rail Choir spiral sigil — Spray recognises it from his sketchbook. Witness (Act 1-2): young man saw the shooter — small, pale, not Warriors colours, already moving BEFORE the shot, lips moving quietly like counting. Confirms Warriors didn't fire. Gun Hill Butchers (Act 1-3): twelve Butchers on the bounty — run, fight, fast talk (Hard if recognised), or split and stealth. Injuries expected; deaths are not — it's Act One. Transit Sweep (Act 1-4): Doyle's unit forces Wheels to route through service access. Token vision: faceless conductor in uniform, face a pale oval, punching tickets on immaterial paper. Less than a second. Does not repeat. SAN 1/1D4. First Train South (Act 1-5): PA carries counting that stops when anyone focuses on it. Dark empty car immediately ahead. Doc's note surfaces here.

Clues / handouts: Lookout notebook (H2) · Third Rail Choir matchbook · Witness description (H6) · Shell casing (if park searched)

Pacing: Establish dread through texture. The silver eyes. The matchbook. The dark car. Nothing explained. Don't over-explain.

■ ACT TWO — THE MANHATTAN TRAP (~75 min)

Locations: 96th St Station · Service tunnels (ward network) · Velvet Static broadcast · Dark Ride · Union Square Cache · Platform Freeze

96th Street split (Act 2-1): one group finds ward network — chalk binding wards across the entire tunnel system, a containment structure built over decades. Failing north to south since midnight. Other group meets Velvet Lizzies; Dolores operates from fear and can be reached. Broadcast (Act 2-3): Velvet Static names investigators by their birth certificate names, not street names. Second voice beneath Sandy's counts stations and distances. SAN 1/1D4. Dark Ride (Act 2-4): train stops between stations, lights fail. Something knocks on the outside of the car. Twice. Then from the next car forward. Then beneath the floor. Chalk wards on the tunnel wall, intact, in both directions — this section decommissioned three months ago, no crew assigned. Union Square Cache (Act 2-5 — DO NOT CUT): route maps keyed to Spray's sketchbook wards; Ritual Timetable (H4) with 6AM deadline; cassette tape (H3) — Cyrus and Creed/Conductor arguing: 'You'll be the lock. And we will find a key.' After this the investigators know: Cyrus's death was the ritual mechanism; they were framed for the token; deadline 6AM. Platform Freeze (Act 2-6): every person in the station stops instantly — mid-step, mid-sentence — for exactly six seconds. A train arrives on no schedule, passes without stopping. Every car lit, every passenger facing forward at the same angle. The stopped people resume. Only investigators saw it. Count the six seconds aloud.

Clues / handouts: Ward network discovery · Cassette tape (H3) · Ritual timetable (H4) · Route maps

Pacing: Union Square is the scenario's pivot. Everything before is mystery; everything after is a race. Protect it narratively.

■ ACT THREE — THE LAST TRAIN (~45 min)

Locations: Brooklyn approach · Moving fight through connecting cars · Stillwell Avenue Terminal

Brooklyn Approach (Act 3-1): last workable southbound. Three teenagers in prom wear in the adjacent car — untouched by the night. Name this moment for Rook (she's thinking about Marco). Creed boards at an unlit stop — revolver on his knee, pointed away. Offers to clear the Warriors' names for the token. Entirely credible. Lying about every element. Psychology (Hard): he's measuring, not negotiating. Spot Hidden (Normal): revolver barrel blackened with the same residue as the summit shell casing. Cult Strike (Act 3-2): four Third Rail Choir enforcers plus Sister Vale board at the final stop. Moving fight car-to-car. Vale does not fight unless an enforcer dies in front of her. Isolated or exposed to the cassette: Persuade (Hard, Normal if cassette played). She is not certain the emergence is salvation. Stillwell Terminal (Act 3-3): maintenance rails warped into the Choir sigil in iron at room scale. Black water on the tunnel floor conducts freely. Breaker box — 1920s hardware, shrine's anchor, one empty slot machined to an unusual specification. The token fits exactly. It was always meant to. The Black Conductor does not arrive with drama. It is simply there — assembled from cinders, ticket stubs, wire, soot. 'This is the last stop. All passengers must exit here.' POW roll to place token. Success: gate sealed, electrical discharge, Creed does not survive the arc. SAN 1D8 permanent.

Clues / handouts: Token placed in breaker box relay · Creed's revolver residue (Spot Hidden)

Pacing: Creed's parley should feel like it might be the way out. Spot Hidden closes that door. Stillwell: BRIEF — one sentence on the Conductor.

■ EPILOGUE — DAWN ON THE BEACH (~15 min)

Locations: Coney Island boardwalk

Address each investigator and their personal hook. Three outcomes: A — Expose the Truth: Masai hears the cassette, gang justice turns on Creed, Warriors walk the boardwalk as light comes up, Rook gets home before Marco wakes. B — Seal the Line: gate sealed quietly; marked investigator does not tell the others what they felt when the power went through the token; Doc eventually learns the Riff runner was discharged from Kings County without record. C — The Long Defeat: investigators reach the beach; every arriving train carries one more passenger than the manifest; Sandy Drucker broadcasts around the clock; Marion Vale doesn't report for her shift; not found for eleven days. Minimum 15 minutes. These characters earned the epilogue.

Pacing: *Spend one sentence on each investigator's personal hook. Do not rush.*

KEY NPCS

Lester Creed *Main antagonist / Third Rail Choir vessel*

Fighting 70%, Firearms 65%, Fast Talk 80%, Occult 85% · HP 15 · Armour 2pts (unnatural resilience)

Deploy: glimpse Act 1 · parley Act 2 · confrontation Act 3 only. Calm, never menacing. Let Spot Hidden do the menacing.

Sister Marion Vale *Third Rail Choir Elder, 61, transit worker*

Has been in correspondence with the entity since age 38. Maintains the Stillwell breaker shrine.

Does not fight unless an enforcer dies in front of her. Cassette tape is the crack Cyrus hoped someone would find.

Sgt Frank Doyle *Transit Police, 44, Vietnam veteran*

Believes completely the Warriors killed Cyrus. Not corrupt. Not a cultist. Will not hear the truth tonight.

Chase and evade only — never fight him. Two intersections in Act 2.

Masai Riffs War Captain, 28

Broadcasting the Warriors' descriptions since midnight. Not a cultist. Furious at being manipulated.

Background pressure Acts 1–2. Possible Act 3 ally (Outcome A only). Anger turns toward Creed when he hears the cassette.

Velvet Static (Sandy Drucker) *Pirate FM voice, 27, Bronx accent*

Unlicensed FM transmitter in condemned Harlem building. Not a knowing cultist.

Never physically present. Has never consciously heard the second voice beneath hers on-air.

Cyrus *Dead catalyst — voice on cassette only*

32. Gramercy Riffs war chief. Dead at Introduction. Was building a cross-gang army against the entity.

Cassette recording in Act 2 only. His voice: steady and careful, not broken. He is the scenario's emotional core.

INVESTIGATORS

Swan (Leon Mercer) *War Chief — the one they follow*

STR 60 CON 70 INT 80 POW 50 DEX 60 · HP 13 · SAN 50

Fighting 60%, Fast Talk 50%, Psychology 60%. Hook: Cyrus made eye contact before the shot — Swan knows he was already afraid.

Spray (Daryl Soto) *Tagger/Scout — knows every tunnel*

STR 40 CON 50 INT 70 POW 60 DEX 80 · HP 10 · SAN 60

Art(Graffiti) 60%, Spot Hidden 60%, Stealth 60%. Hook: his sketchbook has been mapping Choir sites for 2 years without knowing it.

Rook (Ruth Alvarez) *Fighter — kid brother Marco, 12, home alone*

STR 70 CON 60 INT 60 POW 50 DEX 70 · HP 11 · SAN 50

Fighting(Knife) 70%, Intimidate 60%. Hook: carries a blade she wasn't supposed to bring. Conductor learns about Marco when it learns her name.

Wheels (Eddie Carbone) *Transit Runner — every service door*

STR 50 CON 60 INT 70 POW 50 DEX 60 · HP 12 · SAN 50

Navigate 70%, Mechanical Repair 60%, Locksmith 50%. Hook: a sealed IND platform he knows has been accessed — his lock was changed.

Doc (Malik Green) *Street Medic — carries the weight*

STR 50 CON 50 INT 70 POW 70 DEX 60 · HP 11 · SAN 70

First Aid 70%, Medicine 50%, Persuade 60%. Hook: carries photo of Riff runner; on reverse: 'do not ride the last car.'

Mercy (Tina Velez) *Former Turnstiles — swing investigator*

STR 40 CON 50 INT 60 POW 60 DEX 70 · HP 9 · SAN 60

Charm 70%, Stealth 60%. Hook: knows 3 Choir safehouses along the route — all traps. Witnessed Creed wearing a dead man's face.

HANDOUTS & SAN TABLE

H1 — Police Bulletin — NYPD Priority Notice, Warriors wanted for Cyrus's murder, contact Sgt Doyle radio ch.6

H2 — Lookout's Notebook — 'STAY OFF LAST CAR · tokens keep the count off you · silver means it already came through'

H3 — Cassette Transcript — Cyrus/Conductor: 'You'll be the lock. And we will find a key.' [metal scraping]

H4 — Ritual Timetable — station sequence, death of anchor, gate opens +6hrs, token closes gate at Stillwell, after 7AM no known procedure

H5 — Brass Token — slightly larger than correct; spiral-track engraving; three punched holes; always warm since Cyrus pressed it

H6 — Witness Description — 'small / pale / not Warriors colours / already moving BEFORE the shot / lips moving like counting / right on time'

SAN TABLE:

- Silver-eyed corpse (no cause, cold) **0/1**
- Token vision — faceless conductor **1/1D4**
- Broadcast uses real birth-certificate names **1/1D4**
- Knocking on outside of tunnel car **0/1**
- Intact chalk wards extending into darkness **1/1D4**

- Ritual timetable read fully **1/1D6**
- Platform freeze / ghost train **1/1D6**
- First full sight of the Black Conductor **1D6/1D20**
- Full-night exposure (cumulative) **1D4/1D10**
- Sealing the line — token placement **1D8 PERMANENT**